

Curried potato, chickpea, and corn burgers

You may flavor these burgers delicately or strongly depending on your taste for curry. They are a little on the soft side, compared to some of the other burgers, but their taste is **remarkable**. And they make an excellent introductory veggie burger for those who usually eat meat. Top with **Mango Salsa** (page 35) or **Spicy Yogurt Sauce** (page 111).

2 cups cooked chickpeas [320g]

1 pound red potatoes, scrubbed, cut into quarters [500g]

1 medium onion, finely chopped

1 tablespoon vegetable oil

2 garlic cloves, minced

1 large tomato, coarsely chopped

1 small hot chile pepper, minced

1 cup fresh or frozen corn kernels [120g]

2 tablespoons curry powder

1 teaspoon salt

Freshly ground pepper

2 tablespoons dry white wine or vegetable stock

1½ to 2 cups dried bread crumbs [100 to 140g]

1½ teaspoons rice vinegar

½ cup canola or safflower oil, for frying [125ml]

1. Mash the chickpeas in a large bowl or **pulse** in a food processor until a chunky paste is formed. Set aside.
2. **Steam** the potatoes for about 10 minutes, or until soft.
3. Meanwhile, in a large skillet, **cook** the onion in the vegetable oil over medium heat until golden, 5 to 7 minutes. Add the garlic, tomato, chile, and corn. Raise the heat to medium-high and cook, stirring frequently, until the tomato is soft, 2 to 3 minutes. Add the curry powder, salt, and a generous grinding of pepper. Stir and cook for an additional minute or so. When the mixture begins to stick slightly, add

the wine. Cook until the mixture has reduced slightly to a thick sauce. Remove from the heat.

4. Add the curry mixture and steamed potatoes to the chickpeas. Mash the potatoes while mixing them in well. **Mix** in $\frac{1}{2}$ cup [35g] bread crumbs. Add the vinegar and additional salt and pepper to taste. If you feel the mixture is too wet, add more bread crumbs. Let cool completely, then form into 8 patties about 3 inches [8cm] in diameter.
5. **Spread** out the remaining bread crumbs on a clean plate. One at a time, place the burgers on the bread crumbs. Use your hands to carefully coat both sides. Set aside on another plate or clean surface.
6. In a large skillet, heat $\frac{1}{4}$ cup [60ml] of the canola oil over medium-high heat. When the oil begins to shimmer, **fry** 3 or 4 burgers until crispy, 1 to 2 minutes on each side. Look for burgers to be crispy brown on the outside and heated through. Add the remaining oil and, when it returns to temperature, cook the remaining burgers. Drain on paper towels and serve.

MAKES 8 BURGERS

